

Print Content (completed master copy, English)

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- Title: JAPAN ONSEN TRIP
- Subtitle: Hot Spring & Ryokan Planner — Etiquette, Manners & Stay Guide
- Footer line: This planner belongs to: _____

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Page 3 — How to Use This Planner

- Step 1: Read the Onsen Basics and the Etiquette pages before you go — confidence makes the experience relaxing, not stressful.
- Step 2: If you have tattoos, fill in the Tattoo Policy Planner and confirm each place's rules in advance.
- Step 3: Use the Stay Timeline to flow through a ryokan evening: arrival, bath, dinner, sleep, morning bath.
- Tip: Most baths are separated by gender and bathed in without swimwear — that's normal here. Relax and follow the steps.

Page 4 — Onsen Basics

- Onsen = a natural hot-spring bath. A public bathhouse heated with tap water is a "sento" — etiquette is similar.
- Baths are usually communal and gender-separated; you bathe without swimwear after washing first.
- A ryokan is a traditional inn, often with its own onsen, tatami rooms, and a multi-course dinner and breakfast.
- A "private / family bath" can sometimes be reserved if you prefer to bathe privately or as a group.

Decide before you go	Your choice
Day-use bath or overnight ryokan?	
Public bath or private bath?	
Indoor, open-air, or both?	

Page 5 — Bathing Etiquette — Step by Step

Step	What to do
1	Remove shoes where indicated; enter the changing room.
2	Undress fully; put clothes in a basket or locker.
3	Take only your small towel into the bathing area.
4	Sit at a wash station; rinse and wash your whole body first.
5	Rinse off all soap completely before entering the bath.
6	Enter the bath slowly; keep your towel and hair out of the water.
7	Soak calmly; no swimming, splashing, or loud talking.
8	Step out, wipe down with your towel, then re-enter the changing room.
9	Dry off before dressing so the floor stays dry.

- Hydrate before and after; don't soak too long if you feel dizzy.

Page 6 — Onsen Do & Don't

Do	Don't
Wash thoroughly before getting in	Don't get in without washing first
Tie up long hair	Don't dip your hair or towel in the water
Keep your voice low	Don't swim, splash, or play
Fold your small towel on your head or the side	Don't bring the towel into the water
Drink water and rest between soaks	Don't soak so long you feel faint
Re-rinse if you sweated a lot	Don't take phones/cameras into the bath area

- Note: Always follow each facility's posted house rules — they take priority.

Page 7 — The Towel Guide

Most onsen use two towels — know which is which.

Towel	Size	Where it goes
Small "tenugui" towel	hand-towel size	into the bathing area; for washing & modesty; rest it on your head or the side — never in the water
Large bath towel	full size	stays in the changing room to dry off

- Many ryokan provide both in your room; day-use baths may rent or sell a small towel.
- Pack a quick-dry small towel as a backup.

My plan	☒
Small towel provided or packed	☒
Large towel provided or packed	☒

Page 8 — Tattoo Policy Planner

Some baths restrict tattoos; many are fine, and there are good workarounds. Plan ahead so there are no surprises.

Option	How it works	
Tattoo-friendly facilities	Some inns and baths openly welcome tattoos — confirm in advance.	
Private / family bath	Book a private bath to soak without any public-rule concern.	
In-room bath	Some ryokan rooms have their own onsen bath.	
Cover with a patch	A small tattoo can sometimes be covered with a waterproof patch — confirm it's accepted.	
Day-use vs overnight	Policies can differ even within the same place; ask specifically.	
Place / option	Tattoo OK?	How I'll handle it
	☒	
	☒	

- Reminder: Policies vary widely and change — always confirm directly before you go.

Page 9 — Bath & Water Types

Type	What it's like	Want to try?
Indoor bath	sheltered, year-round comfort	☒
Open-air bath	outdoor soak with a view	☒
Private / family bath	reserved, bathe privately	☒
Foot bath	free/low-cost, clothes on	☒
Different water styles	clear, milky, or mineral-rich	☒

- Note: Mineral content and temperature differ by source; signs often list what's in the water.

Page 10 — Ryokan Stay Timeline

Time	Flow
Afternoon	Check in; greeted with tea; change into the provided robe (yukata)
Before dinner	First soak in the onsen
Evening	Multi-course dinner (in-room or dining hall)
Night	Futon laid out; quiet rest; optional night soak
Morning	Morning bath, then breakfast
Late morning	Check out

- Wearing the provided robe around the inn is normal and encouraged.
- My check-in: ____ / dinner time: ____ / check-out: ____

Page 11 — Multi-Night Onsen Trip Planner

Night	Area (region/town — keep it general)	Bath type	Booked?
1			☐
2			☐
3			☐

- Tip: Two nights at one inn lets you fully unwind; one night each suits an onsen-hopping route.
- Soaks I want this trip (count): ____

Page 12 — Booking & Access

Detail	Notes
How I booked	
Meal plan (dinner/breakfast?)	
Private bath reserved? (Y/N)	
Nearest station / transfer	
Pickup shuttle? (Y/N)	
Check-in / check-out times	

- Reminder: Confirm bathing hours — some baths close or switch sides at certain times.

Page 13 — Ryokan Meals & Food

Course / item	Tried?	Notes
Seasonal multi-course dinner	☒	
Local regional specialty	☒	
Hot-pot or grilled dish	☒	
Traditional breakfast set	☒	
After-bath cold drink	☒	

- Tell the inn about allergies or diet needs when you book.

Page 14 — Budget Tracker

Item	Estimated	Actual
Transport to the area		
Ryokan / accommodation		
Day-use bath fees		
Private bath (if reserved)		
Towel rental (if any)		
Meals & drinks		
Souvenirs		
Total		

Page 15 — Packing Checklist

Item	☒
Small quick-dry towel (backup)	☒
Hair tie for long hair	☒
Toiletries / skincare	☒
Waterproof tattoo patch (if needed)	☒
Comfortable slip-on shoes	☒
Water bottle (hydrate after soaking)	☒
Cash for small/day-use baths	☒
Plastic bag for damp towel	☒

Page 16 — Useful Phrases

English	Japanese (romaji)
Is there an onsen here?	Koko ni onsen wa arimasu ka?
Are tattoos allowed?	Tatū wa daijōbu desu ka?
Can I reserve a private bath?	Kashikiri-buro wa yoyaku dekimasu ka?
What time can I bathe?	Nyūyoku wa nanji made desu ka?
Where is the changing room?	Datsui-jo wa doko desu ka?
It's delicious!	Oishii desu!
Thank you.	Arigatō gozaimasu.

Page 17 — Reflection

- Best soak of the trip: _____
- Indoor or open-air favorite: _____
- Best ryokan meal: _____
- Etiquette I felt confident about: _____
- Note for next time: _____